

FOUNDER – CTO AGREEMENT

PulseDNA, Inc.

Founder & Chief Executive Officer: Stephanie Joyce

Chief Technology Officer: Yonggen Jin (Eugene Jin)

Effective Date: January 19th 2026

Term: At-will, subject to milestone-based performance and vesting

1. PURPOSE OF THIS AGREEMENT

This Founder–CTO Agreement (“Agreement”) defines the roles, responsibilities, performance expectations, equity participation, vesting terms, intellectual property ownership, confidentiality obligations, and termination conditions applicable to the Chief Technology Officer (“CTO”) of **PulseDNA, Inc.** (“Company”).

The purpose of this Agreement is to ensure operational clarity, accountability, and alignment in building and maintaining the Company’s federated AI infrastructure, including but not limited to **PulseNEXUS™, PulseTRACE™, and related platform components.**

This Agreement supersedes and replaces any prior oral or written understandings relating to the CTO role.

2. ROLE AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF CTO

The CTO agrees to perform the following duties in a professional, timely, and commercially reasonable manner:

- Architect, build, and maintain the Company’s core technical infrastructure and AI systems.
- Design, implement, and deliver sandbox and production environments according to agreed timelines.
- Implement federated learning, privacy-preserving RAG, model orchestration, and backend services.

- Maintain clear, reproducible documentation of architecture, codebases, and deployment processes.
 - Provide weekly written status updates outlining progress, risks, blockers, and timelines.
 - Communicate promptly and professionally on all operational and technical matters.
 - Support integrations, demos, and deployments for enterprise or government partners as reasonably requested.
 - Follow secure coding standards, clean code practices, and maintain version-controlled repositories approved by the Company.
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3. PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT AND STANDARDS

The CTO agrees to maintain professional conduct at all times, including:

- Business-appropriate communication
- Clear separation of personal and professional interactions
- Timely responsiveness (generally within 48 hours for operational matters)
- Respectful collaboration with leadership and stakeholders
- Strict confidentiality of Company information

Conduct that materially interferes with Company operations, team stability, or investor confidence constitutes grounds for corrective action or termination.

4. COMPENSATION AND EQUITY

4.1 Equity Eligibility

Subject to Board approval and execution of applicable equity documents, the CTO is eligible to earn up to **fifteen percent (15%)** of the Company's fully diluted common equity, earned solely through **milestone-based vesting**.

No equity is vested at signing.

4.2 Vesting Schedule

- Four (4) year vesting schedule
- One (1) year cliff
- Vesting occurs only upon successful completion and acceptance of defined milestones
- Failure to meet milestone requirements pauses vesting until resolved or terminated

4.3 Milestone-Based Equity Release

Milestone	% Equity	Requirements	Target
Milestone 1 – Sandbox Environment	5%	Functional sandbox environment, architecture documentation, recorded demo, reproducible deployment	End of Q1
Milestone 2 – Platform Architecture	5%	Finalized backend architecture, security and access model, core module prototypes	End of Q3
Milestone 3 – Deployable Demo	5%	End-to-end functioning demo, partner-ready deployment, supporting scripts and documentation	End of Q4

Failure to complete a milestone within **thirty (30) days** of its target date may result in **suspension or forfeiture** of associated equity, at the discretion of the Company.

5. PERFORMANCE FAILURE AND NON-COMPLIANCE

The Company may suspend vesting or terminate the CTO role for material non-performance, including but not limited to:

- Repeated missed deadlines without adequate notice
- Failure to deliver agreed milestones

- Inadequate documentation or handoff
 - Persistent unresponsiveness
 - Conflicts of interest
 - Misrepresentation of progress or deliverables
 - Abandonment of responsibilities
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6. UNVESTED EQUITY REVERSION

Upon termination for any reason, all unvested equity **automatically reverts to the Company**.

Any repurchase of unvested shares shall occur at the **original issue price or the minimum price permitted by law**.

This provision is intended to protect Company continuity and stability.

7. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY ASSIGNMENT

All work product created by the CTO in connection with the Company, including but not limited to software, models, architectures, documentation, designs, inventions, and trade secrets, is and shall remain the **exclusive property of PulseDNA, Inc.**

The CTO agrees to:

- Assign all right, title, and interest in such IP to the Company
- Execute an Invention Assignment Agreement
- Execute any additional documents reasonably necessary to perfect ownership

No intellectual property may be retained, reused, or disclosed following termination.

8. CONFIDENTIALITY

The CTO agrees to maintain strict confidentiality of all Company information, including but not limited to:

- Source code and architecture
- Product roadmaps
- Business plans
- Investor communications
- Customer and government relationships

These obligations **survive termination indefinitely**.

9. ACCESS, SECURITY, AND CONTROL

The CTO agrees to:

- Use Company-approved repositories and systems
- Maintain shared administrative access
- Avoid locking, restricting, or withholding access
- Follow security best practices
- Document deployments and credentials

All technical assets must remain **accessible to the Company at all times**.

10. TERMINATION

The Company may terminate this Agreement and the CTO role at **any time, with or without cause**.

Upon termination:

- Unvested equity reverts to the Company
 - IP remains Company property
 - Access credentials must be transferred within **seventy-two (72) hours**
 - The CTO must cease representing the Company
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11. MISCELLANEOUS

- **Governing Law:** State of Delaware (or insert jurisdiction)
 - **Amendments:** Must be in writing and signed by both parties
 - **Severability:** Invalid provisions do not affect the remainder
 - **No Guarantee of Employment:** This Agreement does not guarantee continued engagement
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12. ACCEPTANCE

By signing below, both parties acknowledge that they have read, understood, and voluntarily agree to the terms of this Agreement.

Founder & CEO

Name: Stephanie Joyce
Signature: 
Date: 1/19/2026

Signed by:

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Chief Technology Officer

Name: Yonggen Jin (Eugene Jin)
Signature: 
Date: 1/19/2026

Signed by:

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